

The God of Sticks and Stones

Scripture, Creation, and the Quiet Language of God

Review Packet

Part I

Chapter Eighteen — The God of Sticks and Stones

And throughout scripture,
God continually speaks through ordinary things.

Stick.

Stone.

Seed.

Field.

Water.

Tree.

Simple things.

Foundational things.

Things humanity often overlooks while searching for greatness elsewhere.

Perhaps modern humanity has not truly become more advanced than previous generations.

Perhaps humanity has simply become more distracted.

The pace increased.

The towers grew taller.

The systems became more complex.

But the deepest human questions remain unchanged.

What is life?

What is truth?

What is worth building?

What foundation can endure?

What truly satisfies thirst?

Scripture answers these questions not first through abstraction,
but through living symbols grounded in creation itself.

Water.

Seed.

Bread.

Stone.

Cross.

River.

Tree.

Again and again,

God speaks through things close enough to touch.

This keeps the kingdom near the ground.

Near enough for children.

Near enough for laborers.

Near enough for the poor.

Near enough for farmers,

shepherds,

and ordinary people.

Empire often speaks the language of complexity.

The kingdom often speaks the language of creation.

The stars and the seed tell the same story.

The well and the cross tell the same story.

The river and the tree tell the same story.

Life comes through communion,

through surrender,

through rootedness,
and through receiving what humanity cannot manufacture for itself.

This is why Christ becomes the cornerstone.

And still,
He remains close enough to kneel beside the ground.

Perhaps this is the final invitation of the kingdom.

Not upward striving toward self-made transcendence.

But downward rootedness into reality,
communion,
and love.

To become once again:

- living soil,
- faithful laborers,
- rooted trees,
- people willing to receive living water,
- builders who remember the cornerstone,
- and stewards humble enough to walk with God through the field.

For beneath every empire,
beyond every tower,
and underneath all the noise of human history,
the older realities still remain.

Stone.

Tree.

Water.

Seed.

Dust.

Breath.

And the God who has always spoken through them.

Part II

Closing Reflection A — The Laborer's Return

The work is still waiting for you.

Not the extraordinary kind — just the ordinary. The meetings and the dishes. The conversation that doesn't quite resolve. The commute. The inbox. The neighbor whose name you keep meaning to learn.

You have been walking through something slow and old. And now the ordinary day is in front of you again, with its small weight, asking for your presence.

This is not a descent.

Those who worked close to the ground understood that faithfulness rarely meant stepping away from ordinary life. It meant bringing a different quality of attention into it. Showing up. Tending what was given to them to tend.

You don't have to be extraordinary at this.

You only need to remain present.

And the one who worked with his hands, who ate with people who weren't certain they belonged at the table, has always been willing to meet you in the ordinary hours — in the commute, in the kitchen, in the work that will still be there tomorrow morning.

He did not require spectacle from the people he met along the road.

He is not requiring it now.

So go back to the work.

Quietly, and with purpose — the way a laborer returns after a long rest. The task was always ordinary. And you were always enough to carry it.

Part III

Closing Reflection B — The Tuning Fork

Something has slowed in you, briefly.

It may not stay in exactly this form. The noise will return — it always does. The pace will pick up. The morning after this one will feel more like all the others.

But something will remain.

Not a system. Not a practice. Just the quiet knowledge that the world was speaking before you found this book, and that it will go on speaking when you set it down.

There is a stone somewhere near where you live. Or the sound of wind through something — leaves against glass, a window screen, the gap beneath a door on a cold morning. Small sounds. Ordinary sounds. The kind you stopped registering a long time ago.

They were always there.

That is what this slow walk has been pointing toward. Not toward something new, but back toward what was already present. The language was not lost. Only your capacity to hear it had grown difficult.

You have been quiet for a little while now.

That is enough.

The speaking continues — whether you are attending or not, whether the day is easy or not, whether you remember this or not. It was never waiting for the right kind of person to hear it.

It was waiting for you to get quiet.

You did.

Part IV

Closing Reflection C — The God Who Is Near

You will set this book down, and the room will still be the room.

The same light. The same sounds from outside. The same ordinary weight of whatever the day holds next.

And God will be there.

Not waiting for a more spiritual version of you to arrive. Not requiring that you have understood everything. Simply present — the way he has always been present — within the ordinary hours, patient with the pace of ordinary lives.

He met people at wells when they were just trying to get water. He sat at tables with people who were surprised to be invited. He walked beside two people on a road and let them talk for hours before they recognized him.

He has always been patient with that kind of pace.

The room you return to is not a lesser place than the one this book has inhabited. The ordinary moment — the kitchen, the drive, the quiet morning before anyone else is awake — is not a distance from what this book has been pointing toward.

It is exactly where the pointing has been aimed.

You do not need to go looking for him.

He is already present — within whatever ordinary thing you carry into the next hour, and the one after that.

The invitation has not closed.

Part V

Closing Reflection — The Meeting Place

The room is still the room.

The same light. The same sounds. The same ordinary weight of whatever comes next.

Something has shifted in you, briefly. Not a transformation — a recognition.

The book described a meeting. What it could not tell you — what only this moment can — is that you are already in it.

God was not waiting for you to finish reading. The speaking was not something that would begin once you set the book down and became very still. It was already reaching toward you. Through the ordinary things. Through the hours. Through a life that has always been spoken to, even in the years when you weren't attending.

The woman at the well was not looking for an encounter. She was just trying to get water. The two on the road didn't know they were in a meeting until it was nearly over.

He has always preferred that kind of company.

This is not a descent, returning to the ordinary after this. The ordinary room is where the meeting has always been held — not as symbol, not as pathway, but as the meeting place itself.

You do not need to become more ready than you already are.

He was not waiting for you to find him.

He has been walking with you.